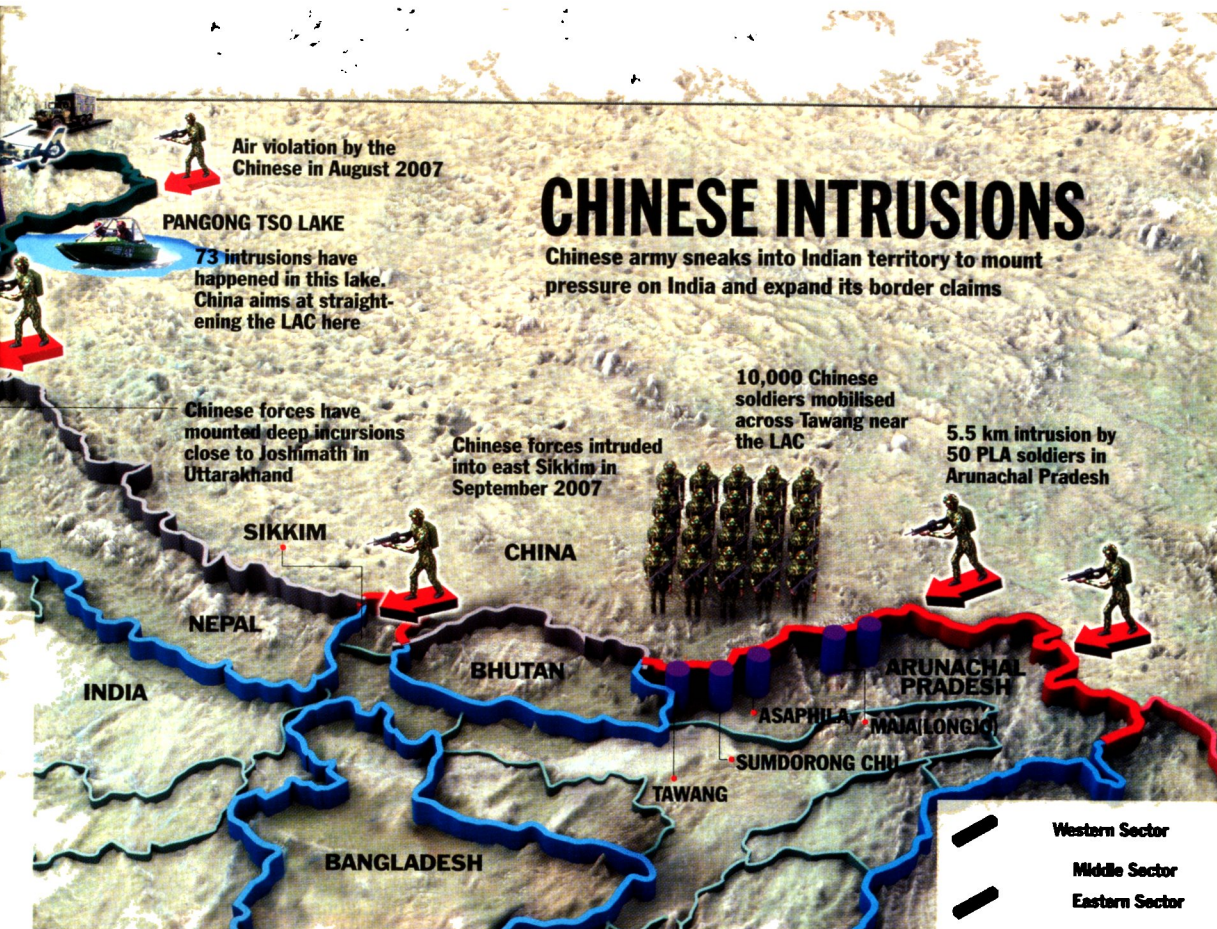




CHINESE INTRUSIONS

Chinese army sneaks into Indian territory to mount pressure on India and expand its border claims

RESSION

division in the North-east.

Officially the Defence Ministry has confirmed that there have been transgressions by the PLA this year but has refused to go into the details. "Some incidents have been reported of Chinese patrols transgressing beyond our perception of LAC in a few areas of Arunachal Pradesh," says Defence Ministry spokesperson Sitanshu Kar.

China's new game of intrusions seems to be a part of its renewed strategy to strengthen its claims on the disputed border areas. There are signs that the Chinese are strengthening their defences and have plans to intrude deeper into the Indian territory all along the 3,350-km-long Sino-Indian border. China and India share the longest boundary dispute in the

world. Ever since the Sino-Indian war of 1962, though the two sides have had skirmishes on the border they have shied away from a conflict. China considers Arunachal Pradesh as a disputed territory and in 1986 the two countries almost went to war in the Sumdorong Chu area. At the centre of the dispute lies Beijing's refusal to acknowledge the Mac Mohan Line as the border between the two nations and staking claim to large tracts of land as a contiguous part of Tibet. While the Chinese claim 90,000 sq km from India, India is seeking 36,846 sq km of land besides 5,080 sq km that was ceded to China by Pakistan. The boundary is divided into three sectors—western (Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh), middle

GAMES THEY PLAY

- Intelligence reports suggest there is a concentration of over 10,000 soldiers across the border in Tawang sector, which means a full division of the PLA has been brought to the area.
- Intelligence reports point to 130 intrusions by the Chinese into Indian territory in 2007. These are timed to gain an upper hand in boundary talks.
- Defence Ministry officially admits to the intrusions but refuses to divulge details.
- The Chinese Army has been intruding into newer areas. On August 25, there was an intrusion in east Sikkim. In 2003, China accepted Sikkim to be a part of India as a trade-off for recognition of Chinese claim over Tibet.